STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	CS-3500

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 01/24/08	DATE REVISED **10/17/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE COURT SERVICES	RESOURCES
SUBJECT COURTHOUSE AND 1102 BUILDING EMERGENCY PLANS	CROSS REFERENCE P-4420 EXPLOSIVE DEVICES

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for courthouse emergency plans.

II. Policy:

The Court Security and Transportation Unit shall have primary responsibility for the safety and security of the Sarpy County Courthouse Complex and 1102 Building during emergency situations. Emergency plans shall be implemented in a safe, orderly and secure manner to ensure the safety of the public and county employees. All employees shall familiarize themselves with the emergency plans. During any emergency situation, the Court Security and Transportation Unit Supervisor shall notify the Court Services Commander, the Assistant Court Services Commander and Assigned Duty Commander.

III. Procedure:

A. Fire/Fire Alarm:

1. General:

a) Any employee detecting a fire should immediately contact Communications. This should be done prior to or simultaneous to any attempt to fight the fire.

b) Fire and Rescue services shall be coordinated with the Papillion Fire Department.

c) If a fire alarm is sounded, all Courthouse doors with a proximity lock will automatically unlock.

d) Elevators should not be used during a fire/fire alarm.

e) ABC fire extinguishers are available throughout the Courthouse Complex and 1102 Building shall be used according to the attached instructions. Fire extinguishers should only be used for newly started or small fires.

f) In case of a fire, the Papillion Fire Department should be requested even if the fire has been extinguished.

2. ESO Responsibilities:

a) ESOs should not allow any person to enter the Hall of Justice and should direct all individuals to exit the building.

b) ESOs shall stay at their stations, as long as it is safe to do so, and assist employees and citizens in exiting the Hall of Justice.

c) ESOs shall leave the building when directed to do so by the Court Security and Transportation Supervisor.

3. Deputy Responsibilities:

a) The deputy shall respond to the alarm activation area and determine if there is an active fire. The deputy shall notify his or her supervisor if there is an active fire, false alarm, or fire alarm testing in progress.

b) Court Security and Transportation deputies shall direct all citizens and employees in the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building to evacuate.

c) Court Security and Transportation deputies supervising inmates shall escort those inmates through the Court Security and Transportation offices, if safe to do so, and secure them in a transport vehicle outside of the garage area. Inmates shall be supervised at all times. The inmates shall be transported to the Sarpy County Jail as soon as practical.

d) Court Security and Transportation deputies shall ensure total evacuation of all persons prior to exiting the building.

e) Court Security and Transportation deputies shall be assigned to all exits to ensure safe and efficient evacuation and prevent unauthorized entry to the Hall of Justice and/or 1102 Building.

f) Court Security and Transportation deputies shall provide perimeter security for the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building until advised to return to the building by the Court Security and Transportation Supervisor.

4. **Court** Security and Transportation **Supervisor Responsibilities:**

a) The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure all Court Security and Transportation Unit personnel are aware of the fire/fire alarm. The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall gather and relay all relevant information to staff.

b) The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure a deputy is stationed at each entrance to the Courthouse complex. The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor may request additional assistance from the Road Patrol Division and/or local law enforcement.

c) The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign personnel to search the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building to ensure that all citizens and staff have been evacuated.

d) The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify the ADC and the Court Services Commander.

e) The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall communicate with fire department personnel and determine when it is safe to return to the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building.

(1) When it is safe to return, the Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign Court Security and Transportation personnel to conduct a security check of the Courthouse complex and/or 1102 Building.

(2) After the security check, the Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify all Court Security and Transportation personnel who shall notify Courthouse and/or 1102 Building personnel.

B. **Tornado Warning:** When a tornado warning is issued by the National Weather Service, all Courthouse personnel and civilians should seek shelter immediately.

1. **General:**

   a) Communications will also make a system wide notification on all radio talkgroups including Court Security and Transportation.

   b) Elevators should not be used during a tornado warning.

   c) If time permits, all persons in the Hall of Justice shall be directed to the basement utilizing the east and west stairways. Persons in the Administrative Wing shall be directed to the Archive Hallway in the lower level. Courthouse employees shall be requested to seek shelter, but shall not be required to do so. Non-employees shall be required to seek shelter or leave the Courthouse Complex.

   d) If time does not permit, all persons should be directed to go to the most interior wall and sit or lie under desks or heavy furniture. Exterior walls, especially windows, should be avoided. 1102 Building employees shall be requested to seek shelter in designated tornado shelters but shall not be required to do so.

   e) Non-employees shall be required to seek shelter or leave the 1102 Building property.

2. **ESO Responsibilities:** Prior to seeking shelter, time permitting, ESOs should:

   a) Ensure the door between the Hall of Justice and the Administration Building is open.

   b) Direct persons to the basement shelter area(s).

   c) Ensure the West Entrance doors are closed, but not secured.

   d) Ensure all electrical equipment is turned off (e.g. x-ray machine(s), magnetometer(s), etc.).

3. **Deputy Responsibilities:** Prior to seeking shelter, time permitting, Security and Transportation deputies should:

   a) Direct all citizens and employees in the Courthouse Complex to the basement area(s).

   b) Ensure all citizens and employees have moved to a designated tornado shelter prior to seeking shelter.

c) Clear and secure all court rooms. Ensure all office doors are secured.

d) Those Security and Transportation deputies supervising inmates shall escort them to the Court Security and Transportation offices and secure them in a holding cell. If inmates are secured in holding cells, at least one Security and Transportation deputy shall seek shelter in the Court Security and Transportation office area during the tornado warning.

4. Court Services Supervisor Responsibilities:

a) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure all Court Security and Transportation Unit personnel are aware of the tornado warning. The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall gather and relay all relevant information to staff.

b) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure a deputy is stationed at each courthouse stairwell to ensure orderly movement into the basement shelter.

c) Time permitting, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign personnel to search the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building to ensure that all citizens and staff have been moved to designated shelters.

d) If on-duty personnel are not sufficient, additional personnel, including road patrol, shall be requested.

e) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall determine when it is safe to return to the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building.

(1) When it is safe to return, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign Security and Transportation personnel to conduct a security check of the Courthouse complex and/or 1102 Building.

(2) After the security check, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify all Security and Transportation personnel who shall then allow Courthouse and 1102 Building personnel and citizens to return to the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building.

C. Bomb Threat:

1. Receipt of Bomb Threat by Phone-Employee Responsibilities:

a) Upon receiving a phone call regarding a bomb threat, the employee shall immediately begin to complete a Bomb Threat Checklist. The employee shall make every effort to obtain as much information as possible.

b) If possible, the employee should alert another employee to monitor the call and assist in gathering information.

c) The employee shall request the location of the bomb and the time of detonation, if that information has not been provided.

d) The employee shall advise the caller that the building is occupied and the detonation of a bomb could result in the injury or death of innocent people.

e) Particular attention should be paid to any background noise which may provide information regarding the origin of the phone call.

f) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall be notified immediately by telephone upon the receipt of a bomb threat. Employees should avoid using portable radios.

2. ESO Responsibilities:

a) ESOs should not allow any person to enter the Hall of Justice.

b) If directed by the Security and Transportation Supervisor, ESOs shall assist in the evacuation of the Courthouse Complex.

c) ESOs shall leave the building when directed to do so by the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

3. Deputy Responsibilities:

a) If directed by the Security and Transportation Supervisor, Court Security and Transportation deputies shall direct all citizens and employees in the Courthouse Complex, and/or 1102 Building, to evacuate.

b) Security and Transportation deputies supervising inmates shall escort those inmates through the Security and Transportation offices, if safe to do so, and secure them in a transport vehicle outside of the garage area. Inmates shall be supervised at all times. The inmates shall be transported to the Sarpy County Jail as soon as practical.

c) Security and Transportation deputies shall be assigned to all exits to ensure safe and efficient evacuation and prevent unauthorized entry to the Hall of Justice and/or 1102 Building.

d) Security and Transportation deputies shall provide perimeter security for the Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building until advised to return to the building by the Court Security and Transportation Supervisor.

e) The Papillion Police Department will be dispatched to assist Security and Transportation deputies at the Courthouse and the 1102 Building with the above assignments.

4. Court Security and Transportation Unit Supervisor Responsibilities:

a) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify the ADC and the Court Services Commander.

b) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall form search teams consisting of two Security and Transportation employees (either deputies or ESOs) and assign each search team a specific area.

(1) If on-duty personnel are not sufficient to conduct a thorough search, additional personnel, including road patrol, shall be requested.

(2) Search teams shall initially focus on areas of public access.

c) Depending upon the perceived credibility of the threat, the Security and Transportation Supervisor may determine the need to evacuate the Courthouse Complex or 1102 Building.

(1) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign CSU members to ensure all offices and locations are evacuated.

d) If no device is found by the search teams, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall resume normal Courthouse Complex and/or 1102 Building operations.

e) If a suspect device is located, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall:

(1) If necessary, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall request emergency fire and rescue respond.

(2) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall request Communications contact the Omaha Police Department's Bomb Response Team and request they respond to the scene.

(3) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall evacuate the area where the device is located, if necessary.

(4) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall assign a deputy(s) to escort and assist the Bomb Response Team as requested.

(5) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall request the on-call investigator respond.

5. Search Team Responsibilities:

a) The area assigned to be searched shall be divided in half. Each Security and Transportation employee shall be responsible for searching half of the area. When each deputy has completed his or her half, the deputies shall switch areas and search the other half of the area.

b) When an assigned area has been searched, the Security and Transportation Supervisor shall be notified and may assign the search team to another area.

c) Search teams shall proceed as above until all assigned areas have been thoroughly searched, or until directed by the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

d) In the event a suspect device is located:

(1) The device shall not be disturbed.

(2) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall be immediately notified.

(3) The immediate area shall be evacuated, at the direction of the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

(4) Searchers shall remain near the area to ensure that the device is not approached or disturbed, except by authorized personnel.

(5) Upon the arrival of the bomb disposal unit, the searchers shall assist as requested until the device is removed or disarmed.

D. Emergency Situations:

1. General:

a) The Court Services Division will determine if there is an emergency situation other than a fire, tornado or bomb threat.

b) The Court Services Division shall develop a system of "safe rooms" throughout the courthouse complex. The "safe rooms" shall be designated areas where employees can seek shelter during emergency situations other than fire, tornado warning and/or bomb threats.

2. ESO Responsibilities:

a) ESO's shall evacuate the building immediately or take cover in a safe room nearest to their current duty assignment.

3. Deputy Responsibilities:

a) Deputies shall respond to the immediate threat.

4. Court Security and Transportation Supervisor Responsibilities:

a) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure all Court Security and Transportation personnel are aware of the emergency situation. The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall gather and relay all relevant information to staff.

b) The Security and Transportation Supervisor may request additional assistance from the Road Patrol, Sarpy County SWAT and/or other local law enforcement.

c) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify communications.

d) The Security and Transportation Supervisor notify the ADC and Court Services Commander.

E. Duress Alarm/Shot Tracker Activation:

1. General:

a) When a duress button is pressed, the following will occur:

(1) A signal is sent to the COURT SC talkgroup.

(2) Each alarm is preceded with three tones followed by a pre-recorded voice description and location of the alarm.

(3) During Courthouse, and 1102 Building, business hours M-F 0700-1700, Court Security will monitor and respond to duress alarms.

(4) For Courthouse and 1102 Building alarms received after hours (nights, weekends, holidays), the LE WEST dispatcher will send two single beeps (alert tone 1) and dispatch the alarm over LE WEST.

(5) A Shot Tracer system has been installed at the public entrance to both the Hall of Justice and the Administration building. Alarm activation will be similar to the duress alarm; three alert tones followed by an announcement of gunshot detected and the entry location (hall of justice or admin).

2. ESO Responsibilities:

a) ESO's shall evacuate the building immediately or take cover in a safe room nearest to their current duty assignment.

Deputy Responsibilities:

a) Deputies shall respond to the immediate threat.

3. Court Security and Transportation Supervisor Responsibilities:

a) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall ensure all Court Security and Transportation personnel are aware of the emergency situation. The Court Security and Transportation Supervisor shall gather and relay all relevant information to staff.

b) The Security and Transportation Supervisor may request additional assistance from the Road Patrol, Sarpy County SWAT and/or other local law enforcement.

c) The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall notify communications.

d) The Security and Transportation Supervisor notify the ADC and Court Services Commander.